

Practice Paper 43 — Answer Scheme

Paper 2 — Comprehension

Sections B & C

Note to teachers and students

- Marks are awarded for **meaning**, not for exact words. Where a quotation is required, it has been indicated in inverted commas.
- Where the question asks for **own words**, a candidate who lifts directly from the text receives **zero** for that mark unless the lifted phrase is unavoidable.
- For language and tone questions, accept any reasonable alternative that clearly fits the textual evidence.

Section B — Text 3 Answer Scheme [20 marks]

Q1. [2] — “Ready” twice

1 mark for identifying that the officer was **not entirely confident** the narrator was ready / was **trying to convince himself** by repetition.

1 mark for explaining that the repetition is a kind of **wishful thinking** — saying “ready” twice does not actually make a young referee prepared for a major final.

Sample answer: The repetition suggests that the appointments officer himself **doubted** the narrator was truly prepared, and was **hoping** that saying the word firmly would somehow make it true. It hints that the narrator had been chosen out of necessity, not because he was genuinely ready.

Q2. [1] — Nervousness before the match

1 mark — Any **one** of:

- He “checked my whistle three times, which is twice more than necessary”.
- He “pretended that my hands were steady” (implying they were not).
- He notices the “muffled thunder of a crowd that was no longer thinking about me at all” (suggesting hypersensitivity to the noise).

Q3. [2] — “A man checking the locks before bed”

1 mark — The comparison suggests **anxious repetition** / **compulsive double-checking**.

1 mark — It shows the narrator’s nervousness manifesting as **small obsessive rituals**; he is trying to feel in control of a situation that is largely beyond his control.

Q4. [2] — “Sounded distant”

1 mark — The narrator feels **detached** / **disconnected** from his own actions; the moment feels unreal to him.

1 mark — It shows the **overwhelming nervousness and disorientation** of the kick-off; events are moving faster than he can mentally process them.

Q5. [2] — Why he gives the penalty quickly

1 mark — He had been taught that a referee who **hesitates** loses **authority** / appears **unsure**.

1 mark — Even an **incorrect** but **decisive** decision is considered better than a **delayed** one, because hesitation invites disagreement and undermines the referee's control of the match.

Q6. [3] — Asserting authority (language question)

1 mark for identifying that the narrator deliberately presents himself as **calm and in control**; **1 mark each** for **two** clearly quoted and explained details (max 2).

Accept any two of:

- “I did not raise my voice” — refusing to shout shows **self-control**, denying the players the emotional reaction they want.
- “the brisk neutrality of a man who has made up his mind” — **brisk** and **neutrality** show **decisiveness without emotion**, projecting that the decision is final.
- “held up a hand, pointed again at the spot” — small, **decisive physical gestures** re-state the decision without engaging in argument.
- “walked away” — **physically withdrawing** from confrontation refuses to dignify the protests with a reply.

Each detail must be **quoted** and **explained**; mere lifting without explanation = ½ mark.

Q7. [2] — Short sentences at half-time

1 mark — The **short, broken sentences** slow the pace and **mirror the narrator's hesitant, fragmented thinking**.

1 mark — They emphasise **isolation** and **emotional weight** — each short sentence sits alone on the page, just as the narrator sits alone in the room.

Q8. [1] — “Nobody whose job it was...”

1 mark — The referee bears **sole responsibility** for the decision; unlike a player, who has teammates and a coach, the referee has **no colleague** to confirm or reassure him. His isolation is part of the job itself.

Q9. [1] — Crowd “against nobody in particular”

1 mark — Any **one** of:

- The writer sees crowds as **fickle** / **changeable** — their hostility is not principled but emotional.
- Crowds simply need something to be against; the referee is a **convenient target**, not a real grievance.
- It shows a **resigned, experienced** understanding of crowd psychology.

Q10. [2] — Calm handling of the late tackle

1 mark each for any **two** of the following actions, **with a brief explanation**:

- He walks **unhurriedly** — the pace itself signals composure and considered judgement.
- He asks the **striker** if he can continue — shows **concern for the player** and gathers fresh information.
- He asks his **assistant by radio** what he saw — shows **consultation**, refusing to decide on impulse.
- He waits for the **trainer** to finish — refuses to be rushed by the crowd or the bench.

Lifting without explanation = $\frac{1}{2}$ mark per point.

Q11. [1] — Tone of the final sentence

1 mark — Any **one** of: **reflective, sober, humbled, contemplative, thoughtful**. (Reject: **triumphant, bitter** — these miss the quiet, retrospective quality.)

Section C — Text 4 Answer Scheme [25 marks]

Q12. [2] — “A small casino in every blazer pocket”

1 mark for understanding **casino** — a place engineered to **capture attention** and exploit it for **profit**; addictive by design.

1 mark for understanding the implication — a smartphone, like a casino, is **not a neutral tool**; it has been deliberately **designed** to be addictive, and pupils carry one with them all day.

Q13. [2] — Evidence that smartphones harm pupils

1 mark each for any two of:

- Pupils in schools with a **strict ban** scored about **a third of a grade higher** in standardised tests.
- The **largest gains** are seen among **lower-attaining** students.
- Late-night phone use **delays sleep** by an average of **43 minutes**.
- **Chronic under-sleeping** harms concentration in class.
- The rise in **online bullying** has been **documented in study after study**.

Q14. [2] — Online bullying “follows a child home”

1 mark — Unlike playground bullying, which **ends when the school day ends**, online bullying **continues at home** through the child’s own phone.

1 mark — There is **no place of safety**; the child cannot escape it even in their own bedroom, which makes the harm **more constant** and **more psychologically damaging**.

Q15. [2] — Self-selecting schools

1 mark — Schools that **choose** to introduce a ban are likely to be **already well-disciplined** / well-run; their good results may be due to that pre-existing discipline rather than to the ban itself.

1 mark — The evidence therefore **cannot reliably prove** that a ban **causes** improvement — there is a problem of **selection bias** / cause and effect.

Q16. [2] — Digital literacy argument (own words)

1 mark — Children will **meet smartphones in life regardless**; banning them at school only **postpones** that encounter, and removes adult supervision from it.

1 mark — The classroom is the **right place** to teach pupils to use a device **thoughtfully** — to verify information, to put the device down, and to **recognise manipulation** by apps and algorithms.

Reject answers that lift “fact-check, to disengage” without rewording.

Q17. [2] — “Single out the children who need them most”

1 mark — A pupil who is allowed an **exception** (medical, accessibility, caring responsibility) may be **visibly marked out** as different from their classmates.

1 mark — The very rule designed to help them may end up **embarrassing** or **stigmatising** the most vulnerable pupils — exposing private information and making them **more conspicuous**, not less.

Q18. [2] — Features of the moderate model**1 mark each** for any two of:

- Phones are **not allowed** in lessons or break times.
- Pupils may **carry them switched off** in their bags.
- **Pouches or lockers** are used for the most distractible age groups.
- **Medical and accessibility exceptions** are written into the policy in **plain English**.
- The policy is **accompanied** by lessons in **digital literacy**.

Q19. [2] — Accompany, not replace**1 mark** — A ban **removes the immediate distraction** but does **not teach** the child **how to use** a phone responsibly later in life.**1 mark** — The two policies serve **different purposes**: the ban manages the classroom, while digital literacy lessons prepare pupils for the outside world. Removing one in favour of the other leaves a **gap** in the school's responsibility.**Q20. [2]** — Effect of the final sentence**1 mark** — It **reframes** the debate: the question is no longer **whether** to act, but **how**, which acknowledges the seriousness of the issue.**1 mark** — The **short, balanced** phrasing gives a sense of **clarity and finality**, leaving the reader with a clear, memorable challenge to schools — to choose a policy rather than ignore the problem.**Q21. [1]** — Overall tone**1 mark** — Any **one** of: **balanced, measured, judicious, thoughtful, evidence-based**. (Reject: **neutral** alone, **angry, enthusiastic** — these miss the careful weighing of both sides.)**Q22. Summary [13 marks total: 6 content + 7 style]****Content points** (½ mark each, max 6 marks). **Eight available content points**; candidates should aim for all 8.**Arguments for a ban (Paragraphs 2–3):**

1. Pupils in schools with strict bans **score higher** in standardised tests, especially **weaker pupils**.
2. Late-night phone use **reduces sleep**, harming **concentration**.
3. Online **bullying** follows the child **home**, with **no escape**.
4. Countries / schools that have banned phones report **calmer corridors, more conversation**, and **fewer behavioural incidents**.

Arguments against a ban (Paragraphs 4–5):

5. A ban **postpones**, rather than prevents, contact with phones — pupils meet them **later**, with **less guidance**.
6. The classroom is the right place to teach **digital literacy** — fact-checking, disengaging, recognising manipulation.
7. A blanket ban **affects vulnerable pupils unequally** — those with medical, accessibility or caring needs **lose more**.
8. **Exceptions** designed to help such pupils may **single them out** / stigmatise them.

Sample full-marks summary (78 words):

Supporters of a ban argue that smartphones lower pupils' grades, harm sleep and allow bullying to follow children home, while countries that have banned them report calmer schools and fewer behavioural incidents. Opponents reply that banning the device only delays the problem and removes the chance to teach pupils to use it thoughtfully. They also warn that a blanket rule penalises pupils with medical, accessibility or caring needs, and that exceptions risk publicly marking those pupils out.

Length count: 78 words from “Supporters” onwards.

— END OF ANSWER SCHEME —